



What are the essential parts of business letters?

英语应用文写作

Layout

Sample Letter 2 - A formal business letter

Thompson Trade Co., Ltd
18/F, Kow Wo Plaza
Causeway Bay
Hong Kong
CHINA
6 October 2001

Howells & Sons Ltd.
45 Park Place
London, SW1E 3Z
UK

Dear Sirs,

We are a large chain of retailers and are looking for a manufacturer who could supply us with a wide range of refrigerators. Please could you send us details of the refrigerators you advertised in *Business Review* (2001 No. 31)?

Thank you

Yours faithfully,
Martin Lee
(Sales Manager)

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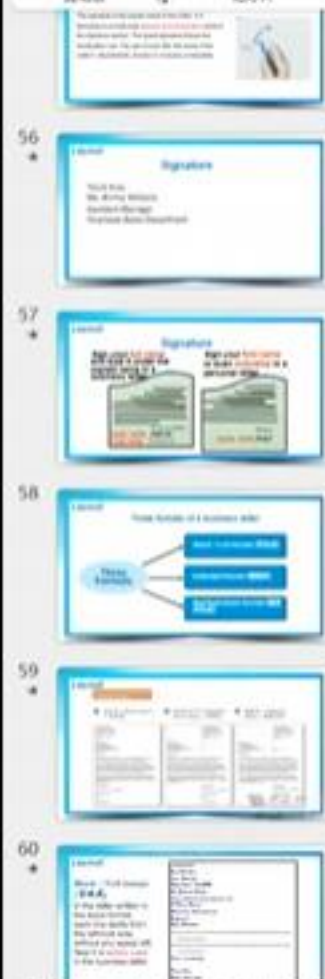
课程

练习

讲义

返回

全屏



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单击此处添加备注

火绒安全

升级完成，部分功能需要重启计算机生效

最新版本：6.0.9.1

最后检查时间：2026-02-05 19:19

新U盘设备接入

1882778153663



Layout

Three business letter styles 三种商务书信格式

① 齐头式 (Block style) :
广受欢迎

② 改良齐头式 (Modified
block style) : 亦常见

③ 缩排式 (indented
style) : 逐渐少用

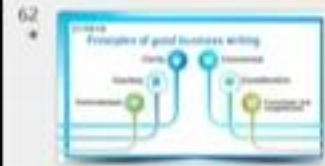




Criteria

Principles of good business writing

- Clarity
- Conciseness
- Courtesy
- Consideration
- Concreteness
- Correctness and completeness



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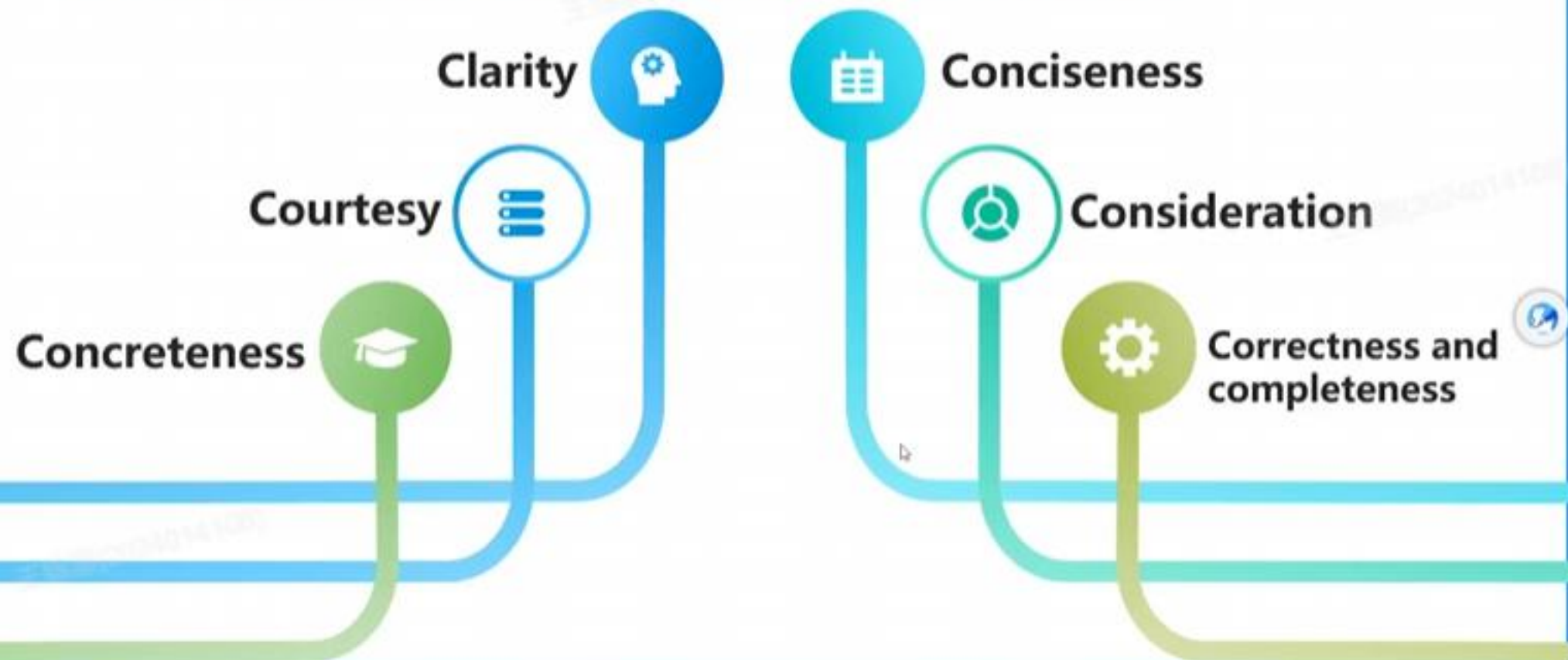
王锦源(2024014108)

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Criteria

Principles of good business writing



Criteria

1. Clarity

The writer should try to express himself clearly, so the reader will understand correctly. To achieve this objective, the writer should be quite **clear about what he wants to say**, and convey his meaning with appropriate words in correct sentence structures.

Use expressions with **precise/accurate** meaning. Don't use words with vague meaning such as "seem" "perhaps" "maybe" "almost". Avoid **ambiguous sentences**. For example, 'It is estimated that...'; 'It seems like...'; 'We perhaps can deliver the goods in April.'



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Criteria

Write in plain English. “plain” means **simple, clear and easily understood**. Expressing yourself in simple English will make your message clear at first reading.

In short, good, straightforward and simple language is what are needed for business letters.



Criteria

2. Conciseness

Conciseness means saying things in the fewest possible words. A concise business letter should say things briefly but completely without losing clarity and courtesy. Follow the Principle 'KISS' (**keep it short and simple**). Use no more words than what are needed to make your meaning clear. Busy businessmen and women today do not have time to read long documents, and they welcome the art of letter that is direct and to the point.



Criteria

In most cases, keep your sentence short and avoid the over-frequent use of such conjunctions as 'and' 'but' 'however'. For these words make sentences longer.

Don't be **wordy**. Use **plain, familiar** words and prefer short words to long words, the single word to the elaborate phrase.

Avoid using such padded expressions as " It should be noted that..." , "due to the fact that..." and etc..

Criteria

• Examples:

I am in receipt of your letter of 8 July which we received today.(✕)

I should be glad if you would be good enough to advise me when it would be convenient for us to arrange to meet to discuss this matter further.(✕)

We require furniture which is of the new type.(✕)

We are writing to you in order to inform you that your order has been shipped out already.(✕)

Please feel free to contact me.(✕)



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- **Examples:**

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- **Examples:**

I should be glad if you would be good enough to advise me when it would be convenient for us to arrange to meet to discuss this matter further.(✕)

Please let me know when we can meet to discuss this matter.(✓)

Criteria

- **Examples:**

I am in receipt of your letter of 8 July which we received today.(✕)

Thank you for your letter of 8 July.(✓)



Criteria

- **Examples:**

We require furniture which is of the new type.(✕)

I should be glad if you would be good enough to advise me when it would be convenient for us to arrange to meet to discuss this matter further.(✕)

Please let me know when we can meet to discuss this matter.(✓)



Criteria

3. Courtesy

Courtesy is, not in using polite phrases, but in **showing a sincere attitude**. It is the quality that enables us to refuse to perform a favor and at the same time keep a friend. The courteous writer should be **sincere and tactful**, **thoughtful and appreciate**.

Deal promptly. Answer letters on the day you receive them if you can.

Respect the receiver, respect their views, and respect their customs and habits.

Criteria

Cold, aloof

Your letter has been received.

Your complaint is being looked into.

It is regretted that the goods cannot be delivered today.

Friendly, warm

We have received your letter.

We are looking into your complaint.

I'm sorry we cannot deliver the goods today.



Criteria

- ☑ Use **active** instead of passive voice. **Active voice** makes the tone more **interesting and lively**, gives your writing a focus, **shows responsibility** and is more **personal and natural**. But passive voice makes your writing vague, denies responsibility and creates a distance between you and your reader.
- ☑ **Never accuse** your reader of making a mistake.
- ☑ Never be unsympathetic, condescending or rude.
- ☑ Always be **grateful** for a favor.
- ☑ Always be **sincere** and **clear**.



Criteria

4.Consideration

Consideration emphasizes **You-attitude** rather than We-attitude. When writing a letter, keep the **reader's** request, needs, desires, as well as his feelings in mind and try to **put yourself in his place**. Plan the best way to present the message for the reader to receive.

Use the language and message **for the reader's needs**. It's also better to focus on the **positive** rather than the negative approach. **Positive writing** will give the reader a better impression and ultimately improve its effectiveness, while negative language triggers negative results.



Criteria

For example:

- If you do not return your form before August you will be too late to attend the conference. (negative)
- I write to send my congratulation. (negative)
- We won't be able to send you the brochure (手册) this month. (negative)



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Criteria

5. Concreteness

To make the message **specific, definite and vivid** is the key point of concreteness. Avoid being too general, vague and abstract, especially when the writer is requiring a response, solving problems, making an offer or acceptance, etc..

Always **aim to include all necessary details** in your letters such as dates, times, figures, sum of money and technical words.

Criteria

For example:

The meeting has been postponed.

These brakes can stop a car within a short distance.

Criteria

6. Correctness

As applied to a business message, correctness means appropriate and grammatically **correct language**, factual **information** and accurate and reliable **figures**, as well as the right **forms and conventions**.

Criteria

6. Correctness

To guarantee correctness of a business letter, the writer should always bear in mind the following:

- Choose only **accurate** facts, words and figures.
- Be **clear** about the meaning of all the terms and jargons used.
- Be **honest** about the things you say.
- Use the **correct level** of language.
- Observe all the **writing principles**.



Criteria

7. Completeness

A business letter should include **all the necessary information**, for an incomplete message may result in increased communication costs, loss of goodwill, sales and valued customers.



7. Completeness



1.1 Layout and conventions of letter writing - 副本 - PowerPoint

文件 开始 插入 绘图 设计 切换 动画 幻灯片放映 录制 审阅 视图 MathType 帮助

剪贴板 剪贴 复制 格式刷 新建 打开 另存为 幻灯片放映 幻灯片放映 幻灯片放映

文字 段落 表格 形状 图表 公式 插入 格式 背景 窗口 帮助

60

61

62

63

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Principles of good business writing

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单击此处添加备注

幻灯片 62 张, 共 137 张 简体中文(中国大陆) 帮助 反馈





設備：標準格式。

51

2025.10.26

44

549

10

WILEY

- 1. 格式与结构 (Format & Structure):
 - 缺少发信人地址 (Heading): 信的开头完全没有发信人自己的联系方式。
 - 缺少收信人地址 (Inside Address): 没有写收信公司和经理的准确地址。
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改错：信件格式

例：~

2025.10.26~

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Dear Manager,~

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Hi, how are you? I write this letter to you because I want to apply for a job in your company. I saw your advertisement somewhere online and it's very interesting. I'm a student from a university and my major is marketing. My English is very good and I am good at computer stuff. I think I am the best person for this job because I am very hard-working. I really wanna get this job. please give me a chance. I wait for your good news.~

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Best wishes,~

Wang~

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- 称谓与结束语 (Salutation & Closing):~
 - 称谓礼貌且不专业 (Salutation): Dear Manager, 过于笼统, 显得没有做任何功课。更好的方式是尝试找到经理姓名 (如 Dear Mr. Smith,), 如果找不到, 也应该用 Dear Sir or Madam, 或 Dear Hiring Manager, 。~
 - 结束语不匹配 (Complimentary Closing): Best wishes, 过于私人化和随意, 通常用于朋友之间。对于 Dear Sir or Madam, 这样的正式称谓, 应使用 Yours faithfully, (美式) 或 Sincerely, (英式)。~
- 语言与语气 (Language & Tone):~
 - 过于口语化 (Too Informal): Hi, how are you?, stuff, wanna 这些都是口语表达, 非常不专业。~



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